

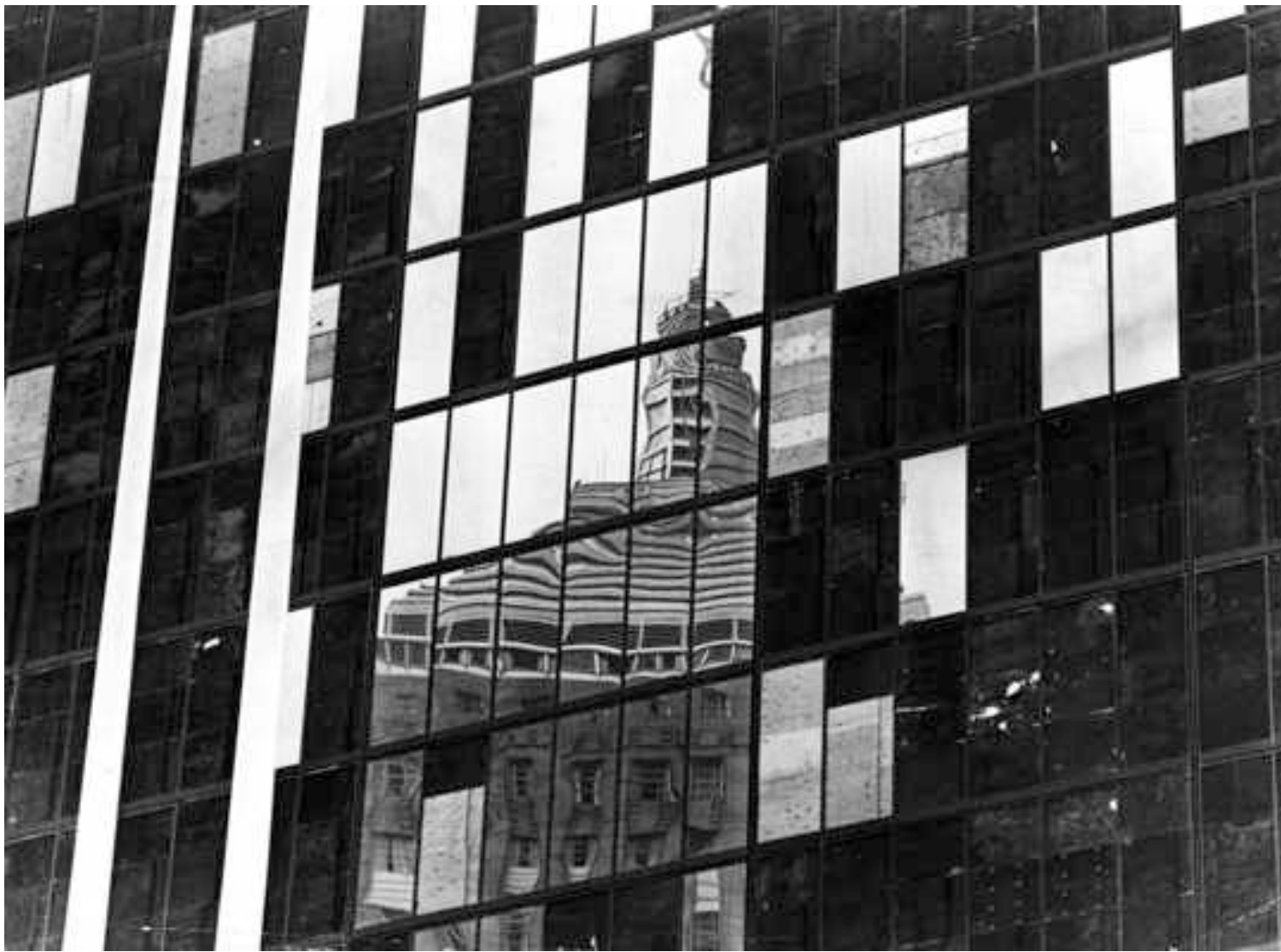
The Boston Globe

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W E D N E S D A Y , S E P T E M B E R 3 0 , 2 0 2 6

LOOKING BACK

When the glass was half empty



50 years after its troubled construction, the Hancock Tower stands tall

Dozens of panels on the John Hancock Tower, each weighing hundreds of pounds, cracked and glass rained down at times during construction. Above, the view in August 1973. At right, spectators looked at a broken window in July 1977.



TOP: JOE DENNEHY/GLOBE FILE; GEORGE RIZER/GLOBE FILE

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

It was known as the plywood palace. Before the John Hancock Tower was an architectural marvel — a gleaming rhomboid stretching nearly 800 feet above Back Bay — it was architectural mayhem, remembered most vividly for the wooden slabs plugging the gaping holes from where the new-fangled skyscraper’s windows had plummeted to the ground. When construction on the tower, meant to compete with the nearby Prudential Center, began in the summer of 1968, it didn’t take long for issues to emerge. Initial excavation work ended up damaging utility lines and nearby buildings, including the landmark Trinity Church. Once the tower climbed skyward, it was found to perform “a sort of cobra’s dance,” swaying and twisting in “ordinary wind conditions,” the Globe reported in 1995, much to the

HANCOCK, Page A10

Many legal immigrants about to lose Medicaid

15,000 in New England among those affected

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

Roughly 15,000 documented immigrants in New England will lose full Medicaid coverage on Thursday, the most recent in a series of deep purges mandated by Congress’s Big Beautiful Bill. The people affected by the health insurance restrictions include refugees, asylum holders, and some groups of parolees and victims of human trafficking who do not yet hold green cards but may be eligible. Many fled war zones. In Massachusetts, an estimated 7,300 people are expected to lose their benefits through MassHealth Standard. More than 8,000 in Connecticut, Maine, New Hampshire, Rhode Island, and Vermont are also expected to lose comprehensive coverage, officials in those states said. This round of Medicaid expulsions is just a precursor. By 2034, changes to the Affordable Care Act and Medicaid restrictions, including work requirements and more frequent eligibility checks that go into effect in January, are expected to reduce the number of insured people in Massachusetts by somewhere between 200,000 and 300,000 by 2034. Hospitals and community health centers expect to see their revenue from Medicaid decline as their count of uninsured patients surges. “All hospitals, especially those that are heavily reliant on Medicaid, are going to be threatened,” said Daniel McHale, a senior vice president with the Massachusetts Health and Hospital Association.

IMMIGRANTS, Page A7

ICE snapping up four robot dogs for \$1.3m

Boston Dynamics says that if misused, deal void

By Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The four-legged robotic dogs that went viral for busting moves to the rhythm of “Uptown Funk” in YouTube videos could soon be on the prowl alongside federal immigration agents. US Immigration and Customs Enforcement will spend about \$1.3 million on four of the robots in a deal with Connecticut company Radeco, which modifies the original machines from Waltham-based company Boston Dynamics with military grade add-ons that include a robotic arm, thermal camera, and sensors for explosive materials, according to a federal contract document released Monday. The original machines from Boston Dynamics were nicknamed Spot. But Radeco’s modified robot opts for something with more teeth to it, naming their robot Cerberus, after the mythical three-headed dog that guards the gates of hell. The robots will be used as an “additional tool to safely assess potentially dangerous situations before placing personnel or the public at risk,” an ICE spokesperson said.

ROBOTS, Page A7

No jail for men in brothel case, but some were ID’d

Advocates for women see progress in treatment of johns

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

Nine months of probation, a \$2,000 fine, and mandatory attendance at classes about the harms caused by paying for sex. No criminal record. Those are the legal consequences

for each of the more than 30 men charged with buying sex at the brothel ring that operated out of luxury apartments near Alewife. The operation was busted in what became a high-profile case that drew widespread attention for the brothel’s sophisticated organization and its socially elite clientele. The case was also unique in that some of the so-called johns, or alleged clients of the brothel, were publicly identified, while the women

who were paid to perform sex acts were not — what many saw as a recognition of the exploitative nature of the illicit industry and the power imbalances between the men buying sex and the women selling it. The spotlight on what are known as the johns had largely been missing in previous brothel prosecutions, said former sex worker Audrey Morrissey, who now advocates on behalf of exploited women. And, she said, it’s the missing piece in

making sure the well-to-do men whose money keeps the trade afloat think twice. “It’s power and privilege,” said Morrissey, who now runs My Life My Choice, a Boston-based nonprofit focused on ending sexual exploitation. “People want to protect their identities because of their status.” In this case, the shame each client experienced could have been the worst consequence of them all.

BROTHELS, Page A10

Odds just as long as Deaton makes another Senate bid

Republican targets Markey, walks a fine line on Trump

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

MIDDLEBOROUGH — He lost two years ago to Elizabeth Warren — and it wasn’t close. The Republican Party faces tremendous headwinds going into the midterms. Polls suggest voters are unhappy with President Trump — especially in Massachusetts. So why is John Deaton running again? The 59-year-old attorney, former Marine, and cryptocurrency booster is in the midst of his second Senate bid in as

many election cycles, challenging Senator Ed Markey, the Democratic incumbent, two years after losing to Warren by 20 percentage points. He’s already loaned his campaign \$1 million — after putting at least \$1 million of his own money into his race against Warren — and is recycling his argument against Warren, casting Markey as too far left for Massachusetts voters. Deaton argues the state would be better off with the independent-minded approach he would bring to Washington, rather than reelecting an 80-year-old incumbent Deaton says has been in office too

DEATON, Page A6

SUDDENLY, SOX ARE ON THE VERGE



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

The playoffs have hardly begun and the Red Sox are in deep trouble after being humiliated by the Yankees in Game 1 of the Wild Card round, 9-0. The Sox must win tonight and tomorrow night to stay alive. **C1.**



The eyes have it

Wednesday: Sun’s back. High 66-71. Low 58-63.

Thursday: Heating up. High 77-82. Low 64-69. Sunrise: 6:40 Sunset: 6:28

Weather, Comics, G6-7.

Lindsay Clancy’s lawyer argued that there was a “complete lack of evidence” showing she killed her three children — despite her admission at trial. **B1.**

A man accused of fatally striking a well-known art collector with his vehicle in Back Bay has been deemed competent to stand trial. **B1.**

The Bruins opened their season in style, knocking off the Rangers, 3-0. **C1.**

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